BIHAR TOURISM
Blissful Bihar

MAHABODHI CULTURAL CENTRE, BODHGAYA

Tourism has emerged as a major industry and has immense employment potential for the state and by 2022, Bihar aspires to be among the top 10 states in terms of domestic visitors and among top 5 states in terms of foreign visitors

One of the primary focuses of the state tourism department has been to rev up the growth of MICE and increase Bihar's share of the global tourism industry pie.

Bodhgaya Cultural Center and State Guest House have been developed as part of State's objective of developing premium infrastructure in Bodhgaya to develop it as a global center of Buddhist Culture and Tourism. These projects will boost the State's Tourism scenario and attract Tourists to Bihar. The Cultural Center is built within the precincts of the UNESCO World Heritage site.

There is an economic imperative behind the race to set up big MICE venues. For starters, it can


Auditorium with 500 seating capacity

help Bihar improve its international tourist arrival figures, especially after the pandemic. Also, there is a lot of downstream spending that happens during business conventions. Most visitors tend to stay on extra days, sampling tourism offerings or splurging on shopping and experiences, and the whole city where the event is held benefits.

And while international conferences are prestigious and bring in large revenue, DOT, Bihar is focusing on the domestic markets, which yields more volumes.

Not surprisingly, the Department of Tourism, Govt. of Bihar is taking up mega tourism infrastructure projects to attract more events, offering unique experiences. Bihar's biggest strength is its variety and diversity of culture. The other big strength is its huge knowledge economy. If we consider that the biggest MICE buyer is the medical fraternity, then the presence of a vibrant population of doctors in Bihar only helps the state's initiative.

Bodh Gaya being an international destination hosts big national and international events. The need for a cultural centre at Bodh Gaya was being felt since long.

To organize events like Bodh Mahotsav, Buddhist conclave, conference of Association of Buddhist Tour Operators (ABTO), the organizers had to look for private space.

As Bodh Gaya is well connected with air, rail and


View of pre-function area


Auditorium with 2000 seating capacity

roads, big events like research oriented international seminars, conferences on Buddhism and culture, meetings, business conferences would be organized in the Cultural centre.

The cultural centre has been constructed with an estimated cost of Rs 153.4 crore. The centre campus is spread over an area of 13 acres. The central government has provided Rs 98.72 crore, while the state government contributed Rs 54.68 crore. Designed with a Buddhist architectural and cultural inspiration, it includes new and innovative technologies of construction. There is a large auditorium of 2000 seating capacity besides one conference hall of 500 capacity and three meeting rooms and one multi-purpose room, the centre includes facilities like auditorium, meeting hall, dining hall, guesthouse, art gallery, audiovisual room of international standards and other state-of-the-art facilities.

Apart from the auditorium, the Cultural center houses a large dining hall having a capacity of 600 persons. There are separate entries for VIPs.

Adjacent to the Cultural center building, a state guesthouse with 100 rooms is also being constructed on the campus. The guesthouse will have world-class facilities.

These facilities aim to provide Tourists visiting Bodhgaya with world class facilities and services to make it a prominent, Iconic, and preferred Tourist destination at a global.

